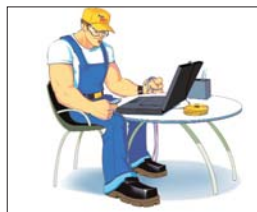




60 The Game's On



76 Write It, Encrypt It, Send It



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Digital Tools

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Jumpstart

A Cell Phone Canvas

M F Husain, India's best known painter is not content with adorning walls. His works will now liven up your cell phone

Preethi Chamikutty

Art, for long, has been the constituency of a chosen few and guarded well by the barriers of price. However, with changing times and evolving technology, art is ready to enter the mass domain.

The most recent step involving technology in this regard is the availability of M F Husain's paintings on cell phones. Swarup Group of Companies (SGI) and Coruscant Tec have taken the initiative of turning this dream into a reality. But is there really a market for such products?

Globally, the penetration of multimedia mobile phones is as

high as 49 per cent. Entertainment services comprising pictures, ringtones and games have reached penetration rates of 30-35 per cent. Mobile entertainment worldwide is estimated to grow to \$11 billion by 2007. In India itself, it is estimated to become a \$1 billion industry by 2009. With such encouraging figures, the mobile content market is just taking off.

Who's Who

Says Guru Swarup Srivastava, chairman and managing director, SGI, "I was looking at adding something more to my investment portfolio; a new dimension to my business is what I was

mainly interested in. Today, there is the option of investing in a mutual fund—art. Here, for example, let's say an investment of Rs 100 crore has to be done in purchasing paintings. A joint investment can be set up between ICICI Bank, BNP Bank, Airtel and any profits earned through the sale of paintings would be earned as a dividend by those involved."

Srivastava looked at the work of about eight to nine different painters before finalising on Husain's work. "I decided on Husainsaab because he is a well-known personality and also an established entity the world over. I realised that the multiplicity factor on investments was higher

Illustration: Binesh Speedhar